

Call for Expressions of Interest	
<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	IBM Bob University Project Marketplace: Self-Service Project Brief Portal
<i>Company:</i>	IBM
Contact Details	
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Additional Info	
<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐
	If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Web application development; content management; search and discovery; analytics dashboards; AI-assisted software engineering; human-computer interaction; accessibility; digital transformation; university engagement; learning technology.
Project Background Information	
IBM works with universities through a growing catalogue of student project briefs, technical challenges, hackathons, SkillsBuild learning experiences and IBM Bob-enabled activities. As this portfolio grows, it becomes difficult for faculty to discover the right project quickly and difficult for IBM to track which briefs are being viewed, downloaded or adopted. This project asks students to build a self-service University Project Marketplace: a lightweight web portal where faculty and students can browse IBM project briefs, filter by topic and technical level, review project details, download briefs and register interest in running a project. The portal should make project adoption easier, reduce manual email follow-up, and create a clearer route from project discovery to university engagement. The project should be deliberately practical. It should help IBM maintain a reusable project catalogue, showcase valuable examples such as AI racing, AR applications, sustainability apps, IBM Bob development projects and enterprise	

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

technology projects, and provide a dashboard view of interest by university, topic and project type.

IBM Bob must be used as a core part of the creation of the application. Students should use IBM Bob to interpret the brief, design the architecture, generate and refine the web application, create sample data structures, build filters and search features, improve accessibility, write tests, debug issues, produce documentation and explain their engineering decisions. The final submission must include evidence showing how IBM Bob was used throughout the project lifecycle.

The preferred solution should be zero-cost or very low-cost, easy for IBM to maintain, and suitable for deployment using GitHub Pages or another static/free hosting approach, with optional integration points for Microsoft Forms, Box links, GitHub repositories, or exported CSV files where appropriate.

Requirements

The group must provide:

- A working web-based project marketplace that can host, categorise and promote IBM university project briefs in a clean, faculty-friendly format.
- A searchable and filterable project catalogue with fields such as project title, topic, technical level, expected duration, required skills, IBM technology focus, target students and downloadable brief link.
- A clear project detail page template that explains the problem, student challenge, expected deliverables, required skills, IBM Bob usage expectations and links to supporting resources.
- A lightweight content management approach so IBM can add, update or remove project briefs without rebuilding the whole site. Acceptable approaches include structured JSON, Markdown files, CSV import or a simple admin workflow.
- A faculty review and interest workflow, for example through Microsoft Forms, email generation, a downloadable pack, or a contact request mechanism. If any personal data is collected, consent and minimisation must be designed in.
- A dashboard or export that shows basic engagement signals such as project views, downloads, expressed interest, most popular topics and university/project fit. If live analytics are not used, the team should provide a prototype analytics model using sample data.
- Explicit IBM Bob integration into the development process, including prompt examples, generated/refined code examples, debugging evidence and a short reflection on how IBM Bob improved delivery quality, speed or design.
- A responsive, accessible user interface that works on desktop, tablet and mobile, with clear navigation for faculty, students and IBM contacts.
- A repository containing source code, setup instructions, sample project data, deployment instructions, test evidence and an operations guide for future maintainers.
- A final demonstration showing how a faculty member discovers a project, reviews the brief, downloads or opens the project pack, registers interest, and how IBM can view or export engagement insight.

Skills

Highly desirable:

- Web development using HTML, CSS and JavaScript, or a modern framework such as React, Vue, Svelte or Next.js
- Ability to design structured data models using JSON, Markdown, CSV or a lightweight content store

Desirable:

- Experience with GitHub Pages, static site generation or low-cost hosting approaches
- Accessibility awareness, including readable colour contrast, keyboard navigation and semantic page structure
- Basic analytics, dashboards or CSV export design

• Practical use of IBM Bob for code generation, debugging, refactoring, testing and documentation • Good UX design for search, filtering, project cards, download flows and responsive layouts • Git/GitHub source control, deployment discipline and clear technical documentation	• Experience using Microsoft Forms, Box links or simple workflow integrations • Interest in university engagement, IBM SkillsBuild, IBM Bob adoption and student employability
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.